

COMMUNICATION PLANNING WORKSHEET

Order Processing Efficiency Improvement Project

1. COMMUNICATION STRATEGY OVERVIEW

Purpose: Ensure timely, relevant information flow to all stakeholders, maintaining alignment and addressing concerns throughout project.

Key Principles:

- Transparency: Share both wins and challenges openly
- Timeliness: Communicate before issues escalate
- Relevance: Tailor messages to audience (executive vs. warehouse floor)
- Two-way: Solicit feedback and address concerns
- Consistency: Use consistent messaging across channels

2. STAKEHOLDER-SPECIFIC COMMUNICATION PLAN

Stakeholder Group	Communication Objective	Message Theme	Channel(s)	Frequency	Owner
Executive Sponsor / Steering Committee	Provide executive visibility on progress, decisions, and risks	Business impact, timeline adherence, ROI tracking	Monthly steering meeting, email updates	Monthly (1 hour)	Black Belt PM
Finance Director / Finance Team	Track financial performance, demonstrate ROI, secure continued funding	Cost tracking, benefit realization, financial milestones	Bi-weekly detailed report, brief in-person	Bi-weekly (30 min)	Green Belt + Finance
IT Department	Coordinate technical requirements, resolve system issues	Technical progress, data requirements, system impacts	Weekly technical sync, instant messaging for urgent issues	Weekly (30 min)	IT Project Member
Warehouse Operations	Guide process changes, manage implementation logistics	Process changes, schedule impacts, pilot results	Bi-weekly operations meetings, daily during pilot	Bi-weekly (45 min)	Black Belt + WH Mgr
Warehouse Floor Staff	Build support for changes, provide training, address concerns	Why changes matter, how it affects daily work, recognition	Shift briefings, team meetings, posters, emails	Daily during implementation, weekly other times	Warehouse Supervisors
Customer Service Team	Prepare for customer-facing impacts, gather customer feedback	Customer impact metrics, complaint trends, satisfaction improvements	Monthly metrics review, email alerts for major changes	Monthly (30 min)	Black Belt
HR / Training	Coordinate training delivery and change management support	Training schedule, content review, staff readiness	Bi-weekly planning meetings	Bi-weekly (30 min)	Green Belt + HR
All Project Team Members	Ensure team alignment and progress on action items	Weekly progress, blockers, next week priorities	Weekly team meeting, shared project tracker	Weekly (1 hour)	Black Belt PM

3. COMMUNICATION CALENDAR - DEFINE PHASE (WEEKS 1-3)

Week	Communication Activity	Audience	Format	Owner	Key Topics

Week 1	Project kickoff meeting	All team members	In-person meeting	Black Belt	Project charter, roles, timeline, expectations
Week 1	Stakeholder 1-on-1s	Key stakeholders (8 meetings)	In-person / Phone	Black Belt	Understand concerns, build relationships, gain buy-in
Week 2	First weekly team meeting	Project team (8 members)	In-person meeting	Black Belt	Progress, issues, this week priorities
Week 2	CTS customer interviews	Customer sample (5-8 customers)	Phone/Video interviews	Green Belt	Understand voice of customer, CTS definition
Week 3	Monthly steering committee meeting	Executive Sponsor + Leadership	In-person meeting (1 hour)	Black Belt	Charter approval, stakeholder status, resources confirmed
Week 3	Finance detailed briefing	Finance Director + Budget Manager	In-person meeting (30 min)	Green Belt + Finance	Budget allocation, ROI model, financial tracking plan
Week 3	All-hands warehouse communication	All warehouse staff (50+ people)	All-hands meeting + email + posters	Warehouse Manager	Project overview, why it matters, what to expect, Q&A
End Week 3	Define Phase Summary / Status Report	All stakeholders	Email + shared document	Black Belt	Phase summary, findings, next steps, measures

4. KEY COMMUNICATION MESSAGES BY PHASE

Define Phase Key Messages:

- "We're solving a real problem that impacts customers and our business"
- "This is a structured approach with proven results"
- "Your input and expertise are critical to success"
- "We will communicate progress transparently and regularly"
- "No one's job is being eliminated; we're making jobs better"

5. CRISIS COMMUNICATION PROTOCOL

If budget cuts occur:

- Immediate notification to sponsor and team
- Escalation to executive steering committee within 48 hours
- Revised plan provided within 1 week
- Transparent communication about implications

If team member leaves / unavailable:

- Notify all stakeholders within 2 business days
- Identify backup within 3 days
- Adjust timeline if critical role affected

If major issue / blocker emerges:

- Issue reported to sponsor immediately (same day)
- Root cause analysis within 2 days
- Recovery plan developed within 5 days
- All stakeholders updated on resolution